Centennial PS School Council
May 31, 2023. 6:30-8:00 pm

In Attendance

Steve Sherlock, Heidi Holmes, Christine Glidden, Harish Pawagi, Julie Turner, Ningsih Dijong, Cheryl Lau

Principal's Report – Stephen Sherlock

• We are wrapping up this year and planning for next year; we have started staffing for next year • The school organization looks fairly similar, but we are down 1 grade 7 class • For staffing, FTE is based on a full-time teacher plus planning support time

• We were originally down three teachers, because we were down 2 classes, but we're now only down by 1 class. As a result we will have 1 teacher departing (a contract teacher, who has a position available elsewhere). The specific teacher departing will be announced at a later date.

• For next year we will have 7 grade 7 classes, 3 of which are French Immersion. We will also have 8 grade 8 classes, 3 of which are French Immersion. In addition, we will continue to have our congregated ACE and enrichment programs.

• Next year we will have some parental leaves, and we will hire temp teachers to cover. • Look for information about staffing changes in August/September.

• We have one retirement to announce. Educational assistant Michelle Craddock, who has been at Centennial for 17 years. She will be very missed!

- Heidi motioned for a retirement gift of $30, Harish seconded; majority voted in favour and the motion passed. Heidi to pick this up for her.

• In terms of extra curricular activities, we have tons of clubs along with track and field. • Some students are working on an Alice in Wonderland production. This production was borne out of a desire for a student club. Students are leveraging props from KCI, who did a similar production this year. Parents will be invited to watch! Look for an announcement regarding the date.

• Upcoming dates of note:

- June 14th – grade 6 orientation. In the school from 6-7 pm.
- June 22nd – grade 8 grad.
- Coffee house (art open house – visual arts, drama, music) – May 25 3:30-4:45
- Regionals 93 students going to regionals for track and field.

Teacher's Report – Nima Hashi

• Nima was away for this meeting, but she shared her notes. Steve Sherlock presented. • Math

- 7-2, 3, 4, & 8:
  - Have concluded their year long infographic projects and are in the presentation stage
  - Currently working on circles: diameter, radius & understanding Pi as a ration between circumference and radius
- 7-1, 5, 6, 7:
  - Students completed their learning of percentages (finding the percent of a

number and percent increase/decrease→ tax, sales)

- Core
  - 8-4 and 8-5
    - We are working on persuasive essays and photo essays
    - We are completing our PSAs for our WE Belong learning centers. Students are working on showing how to break down stereotypes, show allyship and promote equity and inclusion
    - In History class--we are learning about immigration policies that helped populate the west from 1890-1910
  - 8-6
    - informational essay writing and the research process to support learning around writing a reference page
    - Book cover analysis
    - Independent reading choice board to consolidate reading strategies explored in book club earlier in the term
    - Geography- UN 17 sustainable development goals
  - 7-6 and 7-7
    - We have completed our unlearn posters + artist statements focussed on global and human right issues
    - Geography - natural events inquiry project
- Science
  - 8-2, 8-4, 8-5, 8-7: Mousetraps cars and written reflections are complete. Exploring different fluids: how they flow, why things raise in a fluid, float or sink and how they can be used to transfer forces.
  - 7-1, 7-2, 7-3, 7-4: Finished Substances unit with a unit test. Students were taught how to study by developing a study sheet in class; they were able to use this during the last part of the test.
- Art
  - 8-1,8-2,8-3,8-4 are working on some self-selected art works as well as selecting a piece to display for Thursday's Arts Night.
- Music
  - Grade 7 Band - 7-2, 7-4, 7-5, and 7-7 selected their Band instrument a couple of weeks ago after instrument demonstrations by the Grade 8's. They have learned how to care for their instrument and make a sound on their mouth pieces, and are now learning their first notes of the Concert B Flat Scale using simple rhythms.
- Extra-curriuculars:
  - Grade 8 Band, Grade 8 Orchestra, and Centennials Singers continue to rehearse weekly during Nutrition Break in preparation for Coffee House this Thursday
- Gym/Health
  - We are finishing off our track and field season with divisionals and county finals next week. In gym class we will be introducing them to field lacrosse and rugby - both the no contact version.
- French

- Grade 8 French Immersion
    - - finishing up writing a review of something of their choice (movie, restaurant, video game, etc.)
    - - working on spontaneous communication in a variety of situations that might arise if students were to travel / live in a francophone community (ex. eating at a restaurant, going shopping)
- 7-1 Immersion
    - Students in 7-1 are <<living in>> la Résidence Bellevue, a fictitious apartment building in Paris. Students have a character name and they have created a fictitious life with a roommate. We are doing some virtual and some in-person activities including a board games day, Jeopardy and charades. The ages of the tenants in la Résidence Bellevue range from 6 - 314 years old!

• Other cool/exciting things happening at school!

- Coffee House - Thursday, May 25th
- 3:30 PM - Doors & Art Gallery Open
- 3:45 PM - Peformances Begin
- School Food Garden
    - More containers, soil, seeds, and seedlings have arrived for our school food garden. Mrs. Fowler's science classes will be planting them soon.
- Festival of Reading took place in Toronto Harbourfront. Winners were announced for the programs Centennial students participated in programs that are part of the Forest of Reading created by the Ontario Library Association. I was very proud of all the students who voluntarily took part in one or more fun programs of their choice, read at least the minimum to be able to vote (at least 5 out of the 10 books in each program) and made sure to have their voices heard. Especially proud of the students who participated, and managed to vote in all 3 programs, and read all 30 books!! Congrats to all who participated! Happy Reading!

Student Report

• There was no student present to deliver a report during this meeting.

WRAPSC Update – Heidi Holmes

• Trustee came to answer questions.

• Planning to continue with a focus on council best practices into the next year. • We are looking for a volunteer from Centennial to be a WRAPSC representative for the next school year. This involves attending a 2 hour meeting approximately once per month during the school year.

Treasurer Update - Harish

• We try to maintain 3k as float, and we have about 10k available for use.

• We are missing some pizza money for April, May, June (we are expecting this to be around 4k; Harish to get the numbers from Deb).

Community Event – Heidi and Harish

- We got $500 for the pro grant for this event.
- The event went really well! We had a mixture of Erb West and Centennial volunteers. ○ Many thanks to all of the volunteers!!
- We went through all the food Centennial provided, and Jordan (from Carizon) pulled out additional food to serve because the attendance was very good.
- Thoughts about running a similar event in future:
    - Could a future goal be to educate parents about how important it is to be involved with their children's education?
    - If we run an event like this again, we should consider hiring a translator or looking for a volunteer who could help with translation at the event.
    - Maybe in partnership with Carizon, we could provide the materials we developed for families who are looking to get onto school day (to use on the common-use computer at Carizon). Heidi to look into providing this; a laminator is available at the school.
    - Our goal of connecting with the community was definitely achieved!! Let's make this the main goal for next time.
- Thoughts about improving home to school communication:
    - Could students create their own school day accounts for cases where there is a language and/or literacy barrier for their caregiver(s)?
- Expenses
    - $150 for translation, $150 printing costs for informational flyers, Food ($108 for ice cream, $277 for meat, $194 for veggies, buns, water, condiments). In total approximately $879.
- We have $500 from the PRO grant, but this has to be spent in specific ways (e.g. only 10% can be spent on food, or $50). Heidi to fill out the paperwork regarding how the event went for the PRO grant; due June 19th.
- Heidi motioned that we provide a donation $250 to community center, Christine seconded; all voted in favour and the motion passed.

Grade 8 Grad

- We have 15 staff members helping out.
- Looking for 5-7 parent volunteers to help set up decorations, etc.
- Heidi motion to allocate up to $800 (including $500 already allotted) to support the event, Harish seconded. Majority voted in favour; motion passed.

Planning for Next Year

- We will continue to meet the 4th Weds of each month. We have planned for the first three meeting dates, and will set the remainder in September.
    - First meeting will be Sept 27th
    - We will also meet Oct 25th and Nov 22nd
- Christine and Harish are willing to stay on in their existing roles, we are searching for a chair or for two co-chairs. Main role is to create an agenda and run the council meetings. We are not anticipating running fundraisers next year because the pizza fundraiser has been very successful.

Instead, we will continue with the pizza fundraiser for the 2023/2024 school year, with staff and students doing most of the work.

- It was suggested that we get input from the teachers and students about what they want (what should we be raising these funds towards).
- Pizza Days
    - Campus pizza was the past provider, Double Double is the current provider. ○ We need to have a conversation around who provides the pizza; Christine to make calls to a few companies to get quotes and determine the vendor for Sept.
    - Will continue doing this on second break, and will likely keep it on Thursday (Steve to confirm this day of the week with staff).
    - Pizzas need to be delivered at 1 pm, this year we ordered Pepperoni, cheese, veggie only after a survey out to the students. It was determined that another survey will not be needed for the next school year, and we can continue with the same offerings. ○ Plan to start pizza days in Sept and keep the block ordering.

Summary of 2022/2023 Council Year

• Started with online meetings, and have moved to hybrid (in person and online). • Fundraising – pizza was successful; will need a plan starting in September for what we are fundraising for.

- Focus on Diversity, Equity and Inclusion; not sure how to get better involvement, but we need to keep having those conversations.
- Want to do another Community event next year.
- There is a Principal profile form, which Heidi is filling out; due May 26th.
- Many thanks to Heidi for her 6 years of service on Centennial council!!!